

and has the use of his hands. But let us now suppose that there may be some reason not to turn on that radio. Suppose it is the moment at which a certain foreign broadcast may be heard, and your government, an oppressive one, has set up punishments for people who listen to that broadcast. Moreover, you know you cannot listen to that broadcast in complete safety, for you suspect there are spies in your house.

Do you or do you not reach out and turn the switch that will bring in the forbidden broadcast? That will depend a great deal upon your subconscious mind. It is not in the conscious mind that we are basically fearful or brave, but down deeper. And so the subconscious will instruct the conscious, unknown to you, and in the conscious will appear the thought known to you:

*Don't do it, you'll end in prison! or*

*I'm going to assert my freedom to listen to what I want to hear, under any circumstances, or even a compromise such as I'm going to see if that nosy fellow in the furnished room upstairs is at home, and if he isn't, I'll turn on the radio.*

Take this a step farther. Suppose you say in your conscious mind—I am going to turn on that radio at 9 PM no matter what! But you wish it, rather than believe it, while all the time, in your subconscious, dwells a fear which amounts to a direction that you will *not* turn on the radio. Now the subconscious mind will feed all kinds of evasions and excuses to the conscious. You will somehow manage to come home late, or you will rush into the house just in time and “accidentally” bang into the radio, knock it off the table and smash it. (An honest enough accident, since you will consciously believe it was accidental.) Or you may make an appointment to do something else at the time of the broadcast, and then suddenly remember—when your subconscious allows you to remember consciously—that this is the broadcast time, and how *silly* of you to have committed yourself to another obligation.

Do not read any implication of dishonesty into all this, nor any implication that no consideration should be stronger than one's right to turn on one's radio. Look at it broadly. See that your subconscious mind is your hidden boss.

You probably have recognized this many a time when you have said there is something you simply will not do; it is against your principles. A true principle is a firm belief that is part of you, and can of course be a very useful and necessary thing.